

OWNLY ONCE

CREDIT READINESS KIT

VOLUME 05 OF SIX



EVICTON REPORTING DISPUTE GUIDE

Review the record. Document the error.
Prepare a clear dispute.

COMPLIMENTARY FIELD GUIDE

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FIELD GUIDE

Start with the report used for the decision

This guide addresses inaccurate or incomplete tenant screening and related consumer reporting. It does not overturn an eviction order, seal a court record, or stop an active case.

If a housing provider takes adverse action because of a screening report, the notice should identify the reporting company and explain your rights. A higher deposit, higher rent, or co-signer requirement can also be an adverse action.

Your first steps

- Save the adverse action notice and application details.
- Request the report from the company that supplied it. You have a right to a free copy if requested within 60 days of the adverse action.
- Review the exact record and identify any incorrect facts.
- Gather official records that show what should be reported.

If you have an active eviction case or an urgent housing deadline, contact a local attorney or legal aid promptly. A screening dispute does not pause court deadlines.

FIELD GUIDE

Distinguish the records involved

Record	What to check
Court record	Case number, named parties, filing, orders, and final disposition.
Tenant screening report	Whether the case is matched to the right person and described accurately.
Credit report	Whether a rental collection or other account is accurate. It may be separate from the court case.
Landlord ledger	Charges, payments, credits, and any settlement or satisfaction.

Dispute each actual error with the company reporting it. You do not have to wait for one company to delete a record before challenging a separate error elsewhere.

A dismissal does not necessarily mean a filing never existed. State and local law may restrict reporting or use of particular records. Get help applying those rules to your case.

EVIDENCE CHECKLIST

Build your evidence packet

Possible issue	Evidence to look for
Wrong person	Identity details and case records showing the mismatch.
Wrong disposition	Official dismissal, judgment, satisfaction, or other order.
Missing outcome	Updated docket or final order.
Incorrect rental balance	Ledger, payment receipts, or completed settlement.
Duplicate record	Reports showing the same case repeated.
Record that may be too old or restricted	Relevant dates and the applicable rule or court order.

Reporting company and report date

Court and case number

The exact correction I am requesting

BEFORE YOU SEND

Prepare and send your packet

- Replace every bracketed field. Remove statements that do not match your experience.
- Use the company's current official dispute address or online process.
- Identify the disputed account and explain the exact error, the supporting facts, and the correction requested.
- Include copies of relevant documents. Keep your originals. Supply identifying information according to the recipient's requirements.
- Save the completed letter and every attachment. For mailed disputes, certified mail with a return receipt can document delivery.
- Record receipt and response dates. Review the result before deciding on a follow-up.

These templates are educational tools for factual, good-faith disputes. They are not legal advice and do not promise deletion, a score increase, funding, or housing approval.

Current bureau instructions

[Equifax dispute instructions](#)

[Experian dispute instructions](#)

[TransUnion dispute instructions](#)

CUSTOMIZABLE LETTER

01 Tenant screening dispute

Use for an actual error in the report supplied to a housing provider.

[Your full name]

[Mailing address]

[City, State ZIP]

[Date]

[Tenant screening company]

[Designated dispute mailing address]

Re: Tenant screening error for [court or case identifier]

I am disputing an item in your tenant screening report dated [date], reference [number]. It lists [court, case number, party name, and reported disposition].

The specific error is [wrong person, incorrect disposition, duplicate record, or other supported issue]. The correct information is [fact]. The enclosed [court order, docket, or other record] supports this correction.

Please conduct a reasonable reinvestigation and review the enclosed evidence. Correct inaccurate or incomplete information, or delete information that cannot be verified, as appropriate. Please send written results and an updated report.

Sincerely,

[Your signature or name]

Enclosures: [List enclosed copies]

CUSTOMIZABLE LETTER

02 Screening procedure request

Use after receiving a tenant screening reinvestigation result.

[Your full name]

[Mailing address]

[City, State ZIP]

[Date]

[Tenant screening company]

[Designated dispute mailing address]

Re: Procedure request for [case and dispute reference]

I received your reinvestigation result dated [date] for [item]. Under 15 U.S.C. 1681i(a)(6)(B)(iii) and (a)(7), I request a description of the procedure used to determine the accuracy and completeness of the disputed information.

Please include the business name and address of any furnisher contacted and its telephone number if reasonably available. Please provide the description within 15 days after receiving this request.

The report concerns [court and case number]. My original dispute identified [specific issue]. Please send your response to my address above.

Sincerely,

[Your signature or name]

Enclosures: [List enclosed copies]

CUSTOMIZABLE LETTER

03 Related credit report error

Use only if a separate credit report contains a specific related error.

[Your full name]

[Mailing address]

[City, State ZIP]

[Date]

[Reporting company name]

[Designated dispute mailing address]

Re: Rental-related reporting for [account identifier]

My credit report dated [date] lists [creditor or collection account] with [specific field and value]. I believe this is inaccurate because [factual explanation].

The enclosed [court record, payment record, or other document] shows [correct information]. [If relevant and true: I also enclose the result from a tenant screening company dated [date].]

A correction or deletion by another company does not by itself establish what your report should contain. Please independently investigate the specific error identified above, review my evidence, and provide written results and an updated report.

Sincerely,

[Your signature or name]

Enclosures: [List enclosed copies]

CUSTOMIZABLE LETTER

04 Unresolved screening error

Use when the response leaves the identified error in place.

[Your full name]

[Mailing address]

[City, State ZIP]

[Date]

[Tenant screening company]

[Designated dispute mailing address]

Re: Unresolved tenant screening issue for [case or item]

I disputed [item] on [date], reference [number]. Your result dated [date] states [result]. The current report continues to show [specific error].

The enclosed [record] establishes [fact]. Please review this evidence and the following detail that remains unresolved: [explanation].

Please reinvestigate the identified inaccuracy and correct or delete information as appropriate. Please send written results and an updated report. I have included copies of the prior correspondence for context.

Sincerely,

[Your signature or name]

Enclosures: [List enclosed copies]

FIELD GUIDE

Track the next step

Tenant screening disputes generally have a 30-day investigation period, with 45 days in some circumstances; some states require shorter periods. Track receipt rather than the date written on your letter.

Outcome	Next action
Corrected or deleted	Save the updated report. Ask the housing provider whether it will reconsider using the corrected information.
Verified or unchanged	Compare the response with the court records; request the procedure or submit a focused follow-up when warranted.
No response or continuing factual error	Preserve the timeline and check the current CFPB complaint process; consider legal help.
Urgent court deadline	Respond through the court process with qualified help. Do not wait for screening results.

The 15-day period for a reinvestigation-procedure description is not a deadline requiring automatic deletion.

WORKSHEET

Your dispute record

Make one copy for each item and reporting company. Keep this page with the report, evidence, letter, delivery confirmation, and response.

Reporting company and report date

Account or case identifier

Exact reporting error

Evidence and requested correction

Date sent and delivery date

Dispute confirmation or tracking number

Response date and result

Remaining issue and next action

RESOURCES

Sources and next steps

Reference links checked September 14, 2026. Use the official resources below for current instructions and details.

CFPB | Rental denials and tenant screening

[Open resource](#)

CFPB | Disputing a credit report error

[Open resource](#)

15 U.S.C. 1681i | Reinvestigation procedures

[Open resource](#)

CFPB | Credit reporting complaint requirements

[Open resource](#)

Put your next move on the calendar

Visit **itsownlymoney.com** to explore Ownly ONCE financial readiness coaching and complete the assessment. Bring your goals and a list of questions; keep sensitive report documents in a secure channel.

Explore Ownly ONCE and start your assessment

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